July 2, 2020

LIFEWORKSNW

To Whom It May Concern,

This letter is to contact you regarding Ashle Penn. Ms Penn worked with our program, Family Support & Connections through Lifeworks NW from the dates of June 14, 2018 to August 3, 2018. Ms Penn volunteered to participate in our parenting support program after being referred by an employee at the DHS Child Welfare Hotline.

Our program is voluntary and works with families who have identified goals for themselves to improve the overall quality of life for themselves and their family. We assist families in the following areas: identifying goals, removing barriers, information and referral advocacy, support, and encouragement.

During this time, Ms Penn worked with an FS&C Family Advocate who reported to me in a weekly supervision in which we discuss client progress. In order for our program to be successful families must be willing to commit themselves to their goals, work with their advocate, and show dedication and persistence. For the time the Family Advocate worked with Ms Penn, the Family Advocate was impressed with Ms Penn's commitment to providing all she can for her family despite various barriers. She reliably kept her appointments and obligations. She consistently followed up on resources given to secure needed services for her family. Her progress during her time in the FS&C program was exceptional. Ms Penn completed the FS&C Program successfully reaching her goals.

In December of 2019, another referral was made for Ms Penn to the FS&C program from her DHS Family Coach. The referral stated that Ms Penn was seeking financial assistance for utility bills. When I spoke to the former FS&C Family Advocate, she was enthusiastic about working with Ms Penn again. I assigned Ms Penn to work with the same advocate due to their established rapport and prior success.

An opening appointment was scheduled. However, the appointment was then cancelled due to the circumstances of Ms Penn having an open child welfare case. The Family Advocate told Ms Penn that she could not participate in the FS&C program nor receive resources as long as there was an open case with Child Welfare. It is my understanding that no further support was communicated nor alternative resources were given to Ms Penn in this conversation. The Family Advocate requested Ms Penn contact her when the child welfare case was closed. While this qualification is true about our program, with ineligible families I encourage Family Advocates to give as many referral resources, referral agencies, and knowledge as we can.

I regret that this may have caused undue stress and trauma for Ms Penn and I wanted to clarify things in any way possible.

If you have any questions regarding our program, please contact me (information below).

Sincerely,
Betsy McClimans
Program Coordinator
Family Support and Connections
Lifeworks NW
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